



WHEN

August 21, 2026
Doors open at 7:00pm
Meeting starts at 7:30pm
Lecture starts at 8:00pm

WHERE

Unitarian Church
1893 North Vasco Road
Livermore, CA 945571
and via Zoom

TVS QR CODE



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THIS MONTH'S SPEAKER

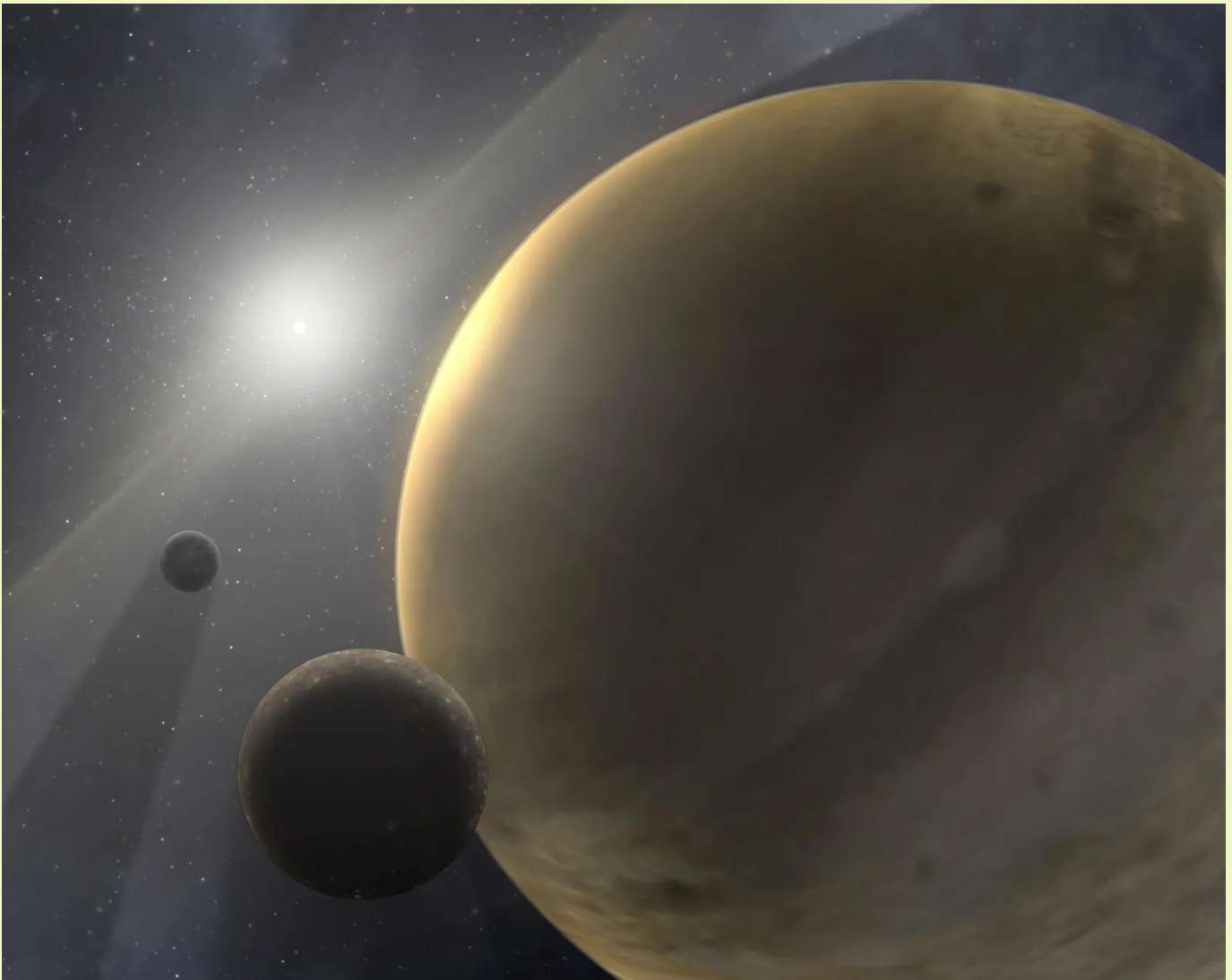
Citizen Science - Contribute to the Science **Ron Kane**

The August talk will describe opportunities for you to participate in astronomy projects. We've seen the Occultation Timing Program (IOTA) in a previous meeting where volunteers take equipment to the field to get timing to aid in determining the shape of asteroids. There's the variable star observer program (AAVSO) and others that use volunteers and their computers for image processing.

These are activities where you can participate and learn more about the science involved. I raise this topic now because TVS has received 3 Unistellar smart telescopes that can be used to contribute to Citizen Science and the Unistellar projects make this easy by providing details on types of observations, how to set up your telescope parameters, downloading data and sending it to Unistellar to be added to the program. Unistellar supports exoplanet research, asteroid occultation timing, Comets, satellites and more. Other science organizations, such as NASA, want you to participate as well but the Unistellar approach may be the easiest to start with.

So, this program is to get you thinking about what else you can do with your telescope and maybe get you recognized as a contributor as well.

Ron has been a member for more than 10 years and has supported a number of roles within the TVS organization.



An artist's interpretation of a gas giant in its planetary system. Credit: NASA/JPL

NEWS AND NOTES

Meeting Dates

Club Meeting	Board Meeting	PrimeFocus Deadline
August 21	August 24	August 8
September 18	September 21	September 5
October 16	October 19	October 3

Money Matters

As of the last Treasurer's Report on 6/22/26, our club's account balance is \$52,242.60, this includes \$14,205.46 in the H2O Rebuild fund.

TVS Welcomes New Members

TVS welcomes new members Christopher Meyer, Narendra Chennamsetty, Leslie Shirley, and Aaron Slamovich. Please say hello and chat with them during our meetings.

2026 TVS Club Star Party Schedule

Save the dates for the 2025 Club Star Parties. Del Valle star parties are also public outreach events. They are jointly hosted with the EBRPD and held at the Arroyo Staging Area (Coords: 37.6196638, -121.7528899). The public is invited for the first 1.5-2 hours, while club members can stay the remainder of the night.

August 22: Club/public star party at Del Valle Arroyo Road Staging Area. Set-up 8:00pm, Observing from 8:30-10:00pm.

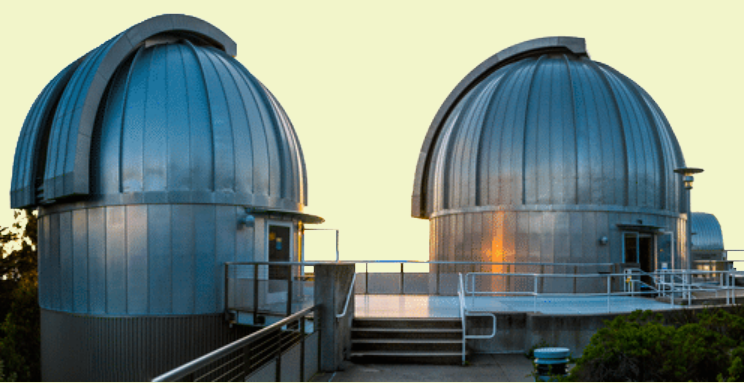
Tesla Vintners star parties are open to only club members and their guests. These star parties end at midnight, but participants can leave earlier, should they wish.

October 10: Tesla Vintner's Star Party, 5143 Tesla Rd., Livermore. Set-up at 6:30pm, Observing 7:00pm-11-30pm.

H2O Open House star parties are open to only club members and their guests. The open house ends at midnight, and all participants are encouraged to stay the duration. The drive to H2O takes about 1 hour, and the caravan leaves promptly from the corner of Mines and Tesla Rds. No gas stations are available on the route, so be prepared. Admission is \$3/car-bring exact change. H2O is a primitive site with two porta-potties. Bring water, food, and warm clothing, as needed. Red flashlights are to be used so observers can preserve their night vision.

September 5: H2O Open House, 5:00pm caravan to H2O PROMPTLY leaves the corner of Mines and Tesla Rds., Livermore. Observing until 11:30pm. Meeting times are tentative.

CALENDAR OF EVENTS



August 21, 22, 28,29, September 5, 6, 12,13, 19, 20, 7:30-10:30pm

What	Free Telescope Viewing
Who	Chabot Staff
Where	Chabot Space and Science Center, 10000 Skyline Blvd. Oakland, CA 94619
Cost	Free

Join Chabot astronomers on the Observatory Deck for a free telescope viewing! Weather permitting, this is a chance to explore stars, planets and more through Chabot's historic telescopes. Chabot's three large historic telescopes offer a unique way to experience the awe and wonder of the Universe. Three observatory domes house the Center's 8-inch (Leah, 1883) and 20-inch (Rachel, 1916) refracting telescopes, along with a 36-inch reflecting telescope (Nellie, 2003).

Are the skies clear for viewing tonight? Viewing can be impacted by rain, clouds, humidity and other weather conditions. Conditions can be unique to Chabot because of its unique location in Joaquin Miller Park. Before your visit, check out the Weather Station to see the current conditions at Chabot.

For more information, see <https://chabotspace.org/events/events-listing/> <https://eastbayastro.org/chabot-telescope-status/>

August 27-29

What	Astronomy @ 250
Who	Astro Society
Where	Virtual - Online
Cost	\$195 for Conference

Astronomy@250 brings together astronomers, historians, educators, museum professionals, science communicators, technologists, artists, and astronomy enthusiasts for a three-day virtual exploration of how humanity's relationship with the cosmos has evolved - and where curiosity, discovery, and exploration may take us next. and how we see the Universe, and the possibilities and responsibilities of the next 250 years.

For more information, see <https://astrosociety.org/events-home/2026-conference-astronomy-250.html>







WHATS UP

Adapted from Sky and Telescope

All times are Pacific Standard Time

August 2026

20	Thu	Moon at first quarter; In the evening looking south-southwest, see the Moon just $1\frac{1}{2}^\circ$ below Antares.
28	Fri	Full Moon

September 2026

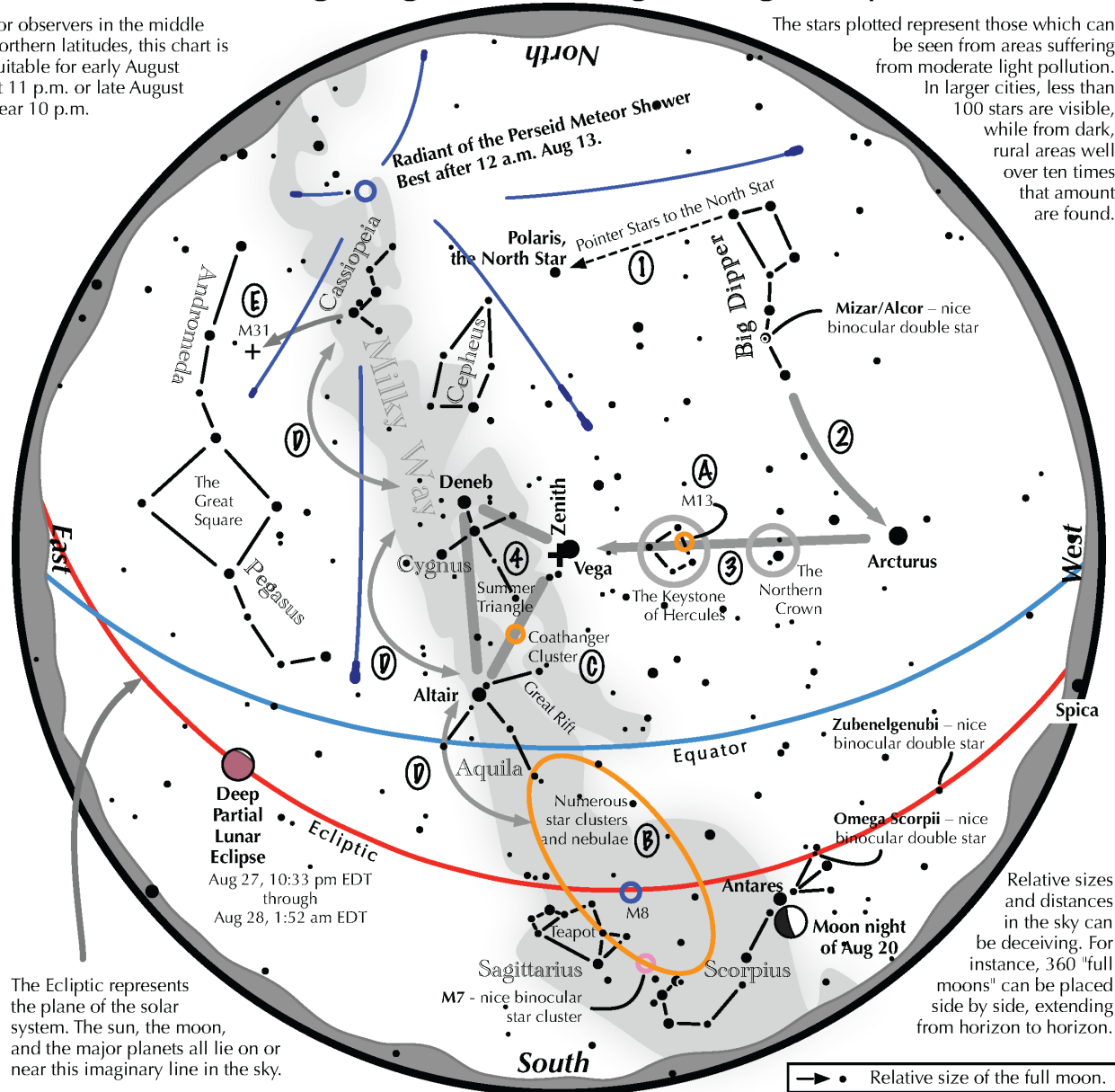
1	Tue	At dusk look south-southwest to see Venus $1\frac{1}{2}^\circ$ lower left of Spica; Algol shines at minimum brightness between 8:53pm and 10:53pm
3	Thu	In the morning, see the Moon just above the Pleiades
4	Fri	Moon at third quarter
7	Mon	Just before sunrise see the Moon with Pollux about 5° upper left, look for Mars to the upper right with Jupiter just below
8	Tue	At dawn see the Moon $3\frac{1}{2}^\circ$ above Jupiter, in much of the US (except the Pacific states the Moon eclipses the planet)
9	Wed	At dawn see the Moon a bit more than 4° apart from Regulus; For the next two weeks look for the zodiacal light in the morning about two hours before sunrise
11	Fri	New Moon
13	Sun	At dusk, looking low the west-southwest, see the Moon with Venus $5\frac{1}{2}^\circ$ to the upper left and Spica $3\frac{1}{2}^\circ$ upper right
17	Thu	While looking south-southwest at dusk see Antares $5\frac{1}{2}^\circ$ to the right of the Moon

OFFICERS AND VOLUNTEER POSITIONS

Officers	Volunteer Positions	Newsletter	Potluck Coordinator
President Eric Dueltgen president@trivalleystargazers.org	Astronomical League Rep. Don Dossa alrep@trivalleystargazers.org	Scott Schneider (Editor) newsletter@trivalleystargazers.org	OPEN potluck@trivalleystargazers.org
Vice-President Aris Pope vice_president@trivalleystargazers.org	Club Star Party Coordinator Tom Dossa coordinator@trivalleystargazers.org	Webmaster Swaroop Shere webmaster@trivalleystargazers.org	Program Coordinator Ron Kane programs@trivalleystargazers.org
Treasurer Ernest Epley treasurer@trivalleystargazers.org	Del Valle Coordinator Dave Wiltzius delvalle@trivalleystargazers.org	Night Sky Network Rep. Ross Gaunt nnsn@trivalleystargazers.org	Publicity and Fundraising OPEN publicity@trivalleystargazers.org
Secretary Dave Lackey secretary@trivalleystargazers.org	Historian OPEN historian@trivalleystargazers.org	H2O Observatory Director / Rebuild Chairman Chuck Grant H2O@trivalleystargazers.org	Refreshment Coordinator OPEN
Past President Ron Kane past_president@trivalleystargazers.org	Librarian Ron Kane librarian@trivalleystargazers.org	Observing Program Coordinator Ron Kane awards@trivalleystargazers.org	Web and Email www.trivalleystargazers.org info@trivalleystargazers.org
	Loaner Scope Manager Ron Kane telescopes@trivalleystargazers.org	Outreach Coordinator Tom Dossa outreach@trivalleystargazers.org	TVS E-Group To Join the TVS E-Group just send an email to TVS at info@trivalleystargazers.org asking to join the group. Make sure you specify the email address you want to use to read and post to the group.

2026

The stars plotted represent those which can be seen from areas suffering from moderate light pollution. In larger cities, less than 100 stars are visible, while from dark, rural areas well over ten times that amount are found.



Navigating the mid August night sky: Simply start with what you know or with what you can easily find.

- 1 Extend a line north from the two stars at the tip of the Big Dipper's bowl. It passes by Polaris, the North Star.
- 2 Follow the arc of the Dipper's handle. It intersects Arcturus, the brightest star in the June evening sky.
- 3 To the northeast of Arcturus shines another star of the same brightness, Vega. Draw a line from Arcturus to Vega. It first meets "The Northern Crown," then the "Keystone of Hercules." A dark sky is needed to see these two dim stellar configurations.
- 4 High in the East lie the summer triangle stars of Vega, Altair, and Deneb.

A: On the western side of the Keystone glows the Great Hercules Cluster.

B: Between the bright stars Antares and Altair, hides an area containing many star clusters and nebulae.

C: 40% of the way between Altair and Vega, twinkles the "Coathanger," a group of stars outlining a coathanger.

D: Sweep along the Milky Way for an astounding number of faint glows and dark bays, including the Great Rift.

E: The three westernmost stars of Cassiopeia's "W" point south to M31, the Andromeda Galaxy, a "fuzzy" oval.



Astronomical League www.astroleague.org; duplication is allowed and encouraged for all free distribution.



Tri-Valley Stargazers
P.O. Box 2476
Livermore, CA 94551
www.trivalleystargazers.org

Tri-Valley Stargazers Membership Application

Contact information:

Name: _____ Phone: _____

Street Address: _____

City, State, Zip: _____

Email Address: _____

Status (select one): _____ New member _____ Renewing or returning member

Membership category (select one): Membership term is for one calendar year, January through December.

_____ Student member (\$10). Must be a full-time high-school or college student.

_____ Regular member (\$30).

Hidden Hill Observatory Access (optional): Must be 18 or older.

_____ One-time key deposit (\$20). This is a refundable deposit for a key to H2O. New key holders must first hear an orientation lecture and sign a usage agreement form before using the observing site.

_____ Annual access fee (\$10). You must also be a key holder to access the site.

Donation (optional):

_____ Tax-deductible contribution to Tri-Valley Stargazers

Total enclosed: \$ _____

Member agrees to hold Tri-Valley Stargazers, and any cooperating organizations or landowners, harmless from all claims of liability for any injury or loss sustained at a TVS function. TVS will not share information with anyone except as detailed in our Privacy Policy (<http://www.trivalleystargazers.org/privacy.shtml>).

Mail this completed form along with a check to: Tri-Valley Stargazers, P.O. Box 2476, Livermore, CA 94551.